

They say the name first.

Prototeus. Prototeus. PROTOTEUS.

It echoes through the dark like a calibration error — a signal meant for machines, not for a sleeping human mind. Behind my eyelids a world tears itself apart again: two silhouettes singing against a collapsing sun, a blue beam carving mountains into dust, pyramids folding under the weight of their own history. Memory or hallucination — the line no longer matters.

The ship doesn't care.

My current body — human baseline, male, early twenties — shivers inside the Safe Flight Capsule. The capsule is a transparent sarcophagus lined with coarse, almost organic film; electric pulses crawl along the skin like mapping insects, adjusting blood pressure, disciplining the heart. Outside, the hull groans as the vessel locks onto the subspace rails. The shift hits: a single violent second stretched into a quiet infinity.

Prototeus. The Waking Cycle begins.

My body twitches. The dream widens, tries to swallow me whole.

A small, four-limbed technician glides over the control array, her suit reflecting the error-light flickering red across the capsule. Her voice emerges as a soft, clicking murmur; the ship's translator converts it directly into my auditory cortex:

THE DREAM MUST REMAIN CLOSED.

Sedation deepens.

The capsule breathes me back into the narcotic dark. For an instant my body rises from the pseudo-fluid — pale, slick, confused — like someone accidentally born mid-transit. Then the vessel's owner, protocol or person (it makes no difference), presses the package back into the fragrant, drug-heavy cradle.

From the outside, the jump looks beautiful.

On the orbital station Terpsichore, the crew will see only a brief flare — a false aurora tearing open the asteroid belt between Mars and Jupiter. They call it art. They call it colour. They never feel the way the braking dome blossoms on the ship's nose, never hear the metal shriek of subspace collapsing behind us.

To them, a ship appears.

To us, the body remembers dying.

I surface when the machines decide that the mind can tolerate gravity again.

Flight hallucinations are common among baseline humans.

The unprepared call it prophecy.

The devout call it punishment.

The scientists call it neural compression artifacts.

I call it a side effect.

I wake hanging in the bioclad: a shared gravity bath where dozens of human bodies float in slow, tangled drift. Automatic tools descend like patient metallic insects — scanning, drying, scraping the sedative film from skin. They lift us, rotate us, scrape residue from joints, treat us like soft cargo designed to leak data.

One of the station's resident aliens takes my weight. The creature looks like an oversized quadruped from an extinct Earth habitat — too many eyes, careful movements, a deep sense-reading capability. It does not speak; the wall translates its neural pattern into language:

CAN YOU WALK?

"Yes," I answer, because that is the correct response.

The alien — my handler — drapes a synthetic cloak over my shoulders with ceremonial precision. Together we move through the spinal corridor of the Earth-vessel. Around us, newly-awakened passengers stumble in loose clusters, drunk on leftover sedation and fractured visions. Their voices mix into a slow tide of languages dissolving into one shapeless sound.

The hosts glide among the bodies like gardeners tending fragile seedlings. They adjust posture, monitor vitals, repair what the jump has broken. Their manuals call us visitors. Their internal taxonomy calls us unstable biological units.

By the time we reach the transfer lock, the Prototeus vision — the collapsing world, the singing silhouettes — has receded into a manageable scar. Terpsichore glows through the frost-glass of the hatch: layered metal, hidden laws, warm advertisements, cold machinery.

I touch the door.

*It reads my pulse, my ID, my projected utility.
A moment of quiet classification.*

The old voices flicker again — Brother, Sister, the ones who sang as their world died.

Then the lock opens with a soft hiss, and Terpsichore pulls me inside.

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My Role

Narrative Stylist & Tone Director

What I Delivered

- A polished micro-scene in a distinct voice
- Controlled rhythm, sensory detail, and metaphysical undertones
- Demonstration of character POV, atmospheric tension, and world tone
- Writing adaptable for games, fiction, XR, and cinematic IPs

Focus Areas

- Tone & style
- Body-centric imagery
- Cross-media narrative voice

- *Metaphysical & sensory structure*
- *Narrative consistency & mood design*